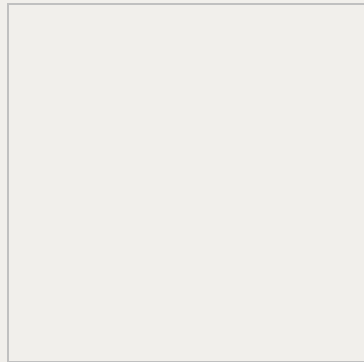


ON TECHNIQUE

Tone poems

Strauss's tone poems are the natural successors to Liszt's symphonic poems, though they far surpass them in vivid characterization and virtuoso use of a vast orchestra. Yet for all their late-Romantic opulence, they never lose sight of the Classical tradition in which Strauss was raised. *Ein Heldenleben* and *Don Juan* are cast in sonata form, while *Till Eulenspiegel* is a rondo. Most ambitious is the Nietzsche-inspired *Also sprach Zarathustra*, famous for its use in the 1968 film *2001: A Space Odyssey*. Its ongoing clash between the keys of B and C symbolizes the irreconcilability of nature and humankind.



ALSO SPRACH ZARATHUSTRA, OP. 30, FRONTISPIECE

Pauline was notoriously abrasive, as evident in the graphic portrait of her in the autobiographical opera *Intermezzo*. However, she was also a gifted singer: Strauss wrote four of his finest songs as a wedding present for Pauline. Published as Op. 27, these include “Morgen!,” a rapt love duet for piano and voice, and the operatically extrovert “Cäcilie.”